

Elementary - I need an assistant! (B0004)

A: ...like I told you before, we just don't have the resources to **hire you an assistant**.

B: I understand that, but the fact is we're **under-staffed**.

A: The timing is just not right. The economy is bad, and it's **too risky to take on new staff**.

B: Yeah, I guess you're right.... here's an idea, what if we hire an intern? She would take some of the **weight off my shoulders**.

A: She?

B: Yeah, you know, **a recent graduate**. She could **give me a hand** with some of these projects and we could keep our costs down.

A: That sounds reasonable... let me see what I can do.

A: Tony, I'd like to introduce you to your new assistant.

B: OK, great! Let's meet her!

C: Hi, I'm Adam.

B: Oh... hi... I'm Tony...

Key Vocabulary

resources

Noun (plural)

money

understaffed

Adjective

not enough people to do the job

the timing is just not right

Phrase

it is not a good time now

weight off my
shoulders

Phrase

remove pressure or
stress

give me a hand

Phrase

help

that sounds rea-
sonable

Phrase

is OK

Supplementary Vocabulary

recruit

*Verb, In-
finitive*

hire

overworked

Adjective

working too much

short staffed

Adjective

not enough people to do
the job

cut costs

Phrase

reduce spending

overstaffed

Adjective

having too many em-
ployees